STORY 6 New Words • The Fastest Rabbit in the Forest

1 **race** [reɪs] *n.* — гонка, забег
A competition to see who is the fastest.
→ Bim won every race in the forest.

2 **cheer** [tʃɪə] *v.* — кричать «ура», подбадривать
To shout because you are happy about somebody.
→ The animals had to cheer him after every race.

3 **tired** ['taɪəd] *adj.* — усталый
Needing to rest or to sleep.
→ Go home before you get tired.

4 **bet** [bet] *n.* — пари, спор
An agreement that the loser must give something to the winner.
→ Then make a bet with me.

5 **prize** [praɪz] *n.* — приз, награда
The thing that the winner gets.
→ The prize is simple.

6 **shell** [ʃel] *n.* — панцирь
The hard part on the outside of a turtle.
→ Bim looked at the old shell in the grass.

7 **whistle** ['wɪsl] *n.* — свист
A long high sound that you make with your mouth.
→ The old owl gave one long whistle.

8 **dust** [dʌst] *n.* — пыль
Very small dry pieces of earth in the air.
→ The dust behind Bim was already far away.

9 **bush** [bʊʃ] *n.* — куст
A small low plant with many branches.
→ He saw something next to a bush.

10 **hop** [hɒp] *v./n.* — прыгать, прыжок
To jump with two feet together.
→ The finish was ten hops away.

11 **nap** [næp] *n.* — короткий сон
A short sleep in the day.
→ He lay down under a tree for a short nap.

12 **rabbit** ['ræbɪt] *n.* — кролик
A small animal with long ears that runs fast.
→ Bim was a rabbit, and Bim was fast.

Useful phrases from the story

pay attention — обращать внимание
Pay attention, everybody. This will be the shortest race of my life.

give up — сдаваться
He has given up. I have won already.

The Fastest Rabbit in the Forest

Bim was a **rabbit**, and Bim was fast. Everybody in the forest knew it, because he told them every day. “I am the fastest animal here,” he said. “Nobody can beat me. Nobody has ever won a **race** against me.”

It was true. He had won against a dog, two birds and a young horse. After every race he sat down in the middle of the road and waited, and the animals had to **cheer** him. Then they went home and said nothing for a long time.

One morning an old turtle came out of the grass. His name was Momo, and he was the slowest animal in the forest. He came with his family, and nobody counted them.

“Bim,” he said, “I can beat you.”

The forest laughed. Bim laughed the loudest of all. “You are slower than the grass,” he said. “Go home before you get **tired**.”

“Then make a **bet** with me,” said Momo. “The **prize** is simple. The loser must take the winner across the whole forest on his back, in front of everybody.”

Bim looked at the old **shell** in the grass, and he thought about a very easy morning. “Tomorrow,” he said. “Pay attention, everybody. This will be the shortest race of my life.”

Every animal came. The old owl gave one long **whistle**, and Bim went like a stone from a hand. Momo put one foot in front of the other. The **dust** behind Bim was already far away.

In the middle of the forest Bim slowed down to have some fun. Then he saw something next to a **bush**. A shell. The same old shell, the same slow feet, walking quietly along the road in front of him.

Bim’s heart jumped. He ran. He ran harder than he had ever run in his life, and he went past Momo, and the trees turned into one green wall. Nobody could run like that. Nobody in the world.

Near the end of the road he could not run any more. He stopped and looked back. Far behind him, small and brown in the sun, Momo sat on the road. He did not move at all.

“He has given up,” said Bim. “I have won already.” The finish was ten **hops** away. He lay down under a tree for a short **nap**.

The noise woke him. It was a big noise, and it was the wrong kind of noise. The animals were shouting and jumping at the end of the road, and they were shouting a name, and the name was not his.

Bim **hopped** to the finish on shaking legs. Momo was sitting there in the grass with the whole forest around him, and every animal was cheering the slowest runner in the world.

“You cannot **prove** anything!” said Bim. “Nobody saw you go past me!” “Nobody saw me go past you,” Momo agreed.

So the fastest animal in the forest walked home very slowly, with a turtle on his back, past every animal he had ever beaten. Behind him, in the long grass, two more old shells were going quietly home to dinner.

